Business Case Document

Display Size Availability and Replenishment Notification System



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Cool Planet Fashion Store

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01. Executive Summary

This Business Case Document looks at a problem in a Cool Planet fashion store where customers can't find the sizes of clothes, they want on the shop floor even though those sizes are in the stockroom. The current inventory management system keeps track of how much's in stock, but it doesn't help with restocking the clothes that are on display in a timely way. This can make customers unhappy cause lost sales and waste employee time.

The main goal of this business case is to find and look at solutions that can make it easier for customers to find the sizes they need make restocking faster and make shopping better for customers. Three options were looked at: an Automated Display Replenishment Notification System, a Manual Display Checking and a Centralized Stock Visibility Dashboard.

After looking at each option doing a cost-benefit analysis and checking the risks the Automated Display Replenishment Notification System was chosen as the choice for the long term. This depends on whether it can work and if the business benefits are as expected. The system will link to the inventory management system and send a message to employees when clothes on display need more stock. This will help employees deal with missing sizes faster cut down delays make use of stock and keep more clothes available on the shop floor.

As a fix the store can start a manual checking system where a specific employee checks the display twice a day. A Centralized Stock Visibility Dashboard could also be used to give a picture of how much stock is in the stockroom and on the shop floor for each size and product.

To make sure this works the store needs records of inventory the new system must work with the old one employee need to be trained roles must be clear and progress must be checked regularly. A test run is suggested to see how well the chosen solution works before using it in the store or other stores.

Overall, this business case suggests using the Automated Display Replenishment Notification System to solve the problem. The solution is expected to make things run better reduce sales help use stock more wisely and make customers happier. It also sets up a base for ways to manage inventory, in textile stores in the future.

02. Options Appraisal

The purpose of this Options Appraisal is to evaluate three possible solutions to the problem of customers being unable to find their required clothing sizes on the shop-floor display, even when those sizes are available in the stockroom.

The appraisal considers three options:

1. Automated Display Replenishment Notification System – connects to the existing inventory management system and automatically notifies supervisors when display stock needs replenishment.
2. Manual Display Checking – assigns one employee to check the shop-floor display twice a day and replenish missing clothing sizes.
3. Centralized Stock Visibility Dashboard – displays stockroom and shop-floor quantities for every product and size on a shared dashboard.

Each option is assessed using the Buy, Build and Outsource approaches to determine its feasibility, cost, implementation requirements and suitability for the textile store.

Option 01: Automated Display Replenishment Notification System

Develop a system connected to the existing inventory management system that monitors shopfloor stock levels and sends automatic notifications to supervisors when a product or clothing size needs replenishment.

Buy / Build / Outsource appraisal

Approach	**Description**	**Advantages**	**Disadvantages**
Buy	Purchase an existing retail stock replenishment solution	Faster implementation. Tested features. Vendor support.	May have high licensing fees. May not integrate with the existing inventory system.
Build	Develop a customized notification system connected to the	Matches the store's exact requirements. Automatic alerts. Reduces manual monitoring.	Development costs. Requires technical skills. Testing and ongoing maintenance.
Outsource	Hire an external software company to develop and integrate the notification system.	Access to specialists. Professional development and support.	Higher service costs Dependence on the external provider. Changes may incur extra charges.

Recommended approach: Build a customized notification system if the existing inventory system provides suitable integration capabilities and the store has access to technical development resources. Otherwise, outsourcing the integration may be more practical.

Expected benefits: Faster replenishment, fewer missed display sizes, reduced employee monitoring time and improved customer satisfaction.

Option 02: Manual Display Checking System

Assign one employee to inspect the clothing displays twice a day, identify missing sizes, check stockroom availability and replenish the shop-floor display.

Buy / Build / Outsource appraisal

Approach	Description	Advantages	Disadvantages
Buy	Purchase a simple checklist application or digital inspection tool to record display checks.	Easy to implement. Provides digital records. Low setup effort.	May involve subscription costs. Employees must still perform manual checks.
Build	Create a simple internal checklist or tracking application for display inspections.	Customized to store procedures. Can record missing sizes and replenishment activities.	Requires development time. Records depend on employees entering accurate information.
Outsource	Hire an external merchandising or retail support service to check displays twice a day.	Reduces the store's direct staffing burden. Can provide trained personnel.	Recurring service costs. Less direct control. External workers may need training.

Recommended approach: Use the existing employees with a standard checklist and assign responsibility for two daily display inspections. This is the simplest and potentially lowest-cost option because it does not require a major software investment.

Expected benefits: Quick implementation, improved display organization and a clear responsibility for replenishing missing sizes.

Limitation: Missing sizes may remain unnoticed between inspections, and the process depends on employee availability and consistency.

Option 03: Centralized Stock Visibility Dashboard

Introduce a shared dashboard that displays the stockroom and shop-floor quantities of every clothing product and size in one place. Authorized employees can use the dashboard to identify available stock and determine which items need replenishment.

Buy / Build / Outsource appraisal

Approach	Description	Advantages	Disadvantages
Buy	Purchase a retail inventory dashboard or stock visibility software.	Ready-made interface. Faster deployment. May include reporting features.	Licensing costs. Limited customization. compatibility issues with existing software.
Build	Develop a dashboard that uses data from the existing inventory management system.	Customized reports. Centralized visibility. Can display product and size quantities clearly.	Development and integration costs. Requires maintenance and accurate stock data.
Outsource	Contract a software development company to design and implement the dashboard.	Professional interface. Specialist integration skills. Potential technical support.	Higher initial costs. Vendor dependence. Possible ongoing support charges.

Recommended approach: Build a dashboard integrated with the existing inventory management system, provided the system can supply accurate shopfloor and stockroom quantities. If internal technical resources are unavailable, outsource the development.

Expected benefits: Better stock visibility, faster employee decisions, easier identification of missing sizes and improved coordination between the stockroom and shop floor.

Limitation: The dashboard will only be reliable if stock movements are recorded accurately and shop-floor quantities are updated regularly.

Comparative Evaluation of the Three Options.

The following table compares the three solutions using indicative assessments. Actual costs and implementation times should be confirmed through vendor quotations and discussions with store management.

Evaluation criteria	**Option 1: Automated notifications**	**Option 2: Manual checking**	**Option 3: Stock dashboard**
Initial cost	Medium–High	Low	Medium–High
Ongoing cost	Medium	Low–Medium	Medium
Implementation speed	Medium	Fast	Medium
Automation level	High	Low	Medium
Employee workload	Reduces routine monitoring	Requires regular manual checks	Reduces time spent searching for stock
Stock visibility	Focuses on replenishment alerts	Depends on employee checks	High, across stockroom and shop floor
Integration requirement	High	Low	High
Risk of missed replenishment	Low if alerts and stock data are reliable	Higher between checks	Medium unless alerts or regular monitoring are added

Overall Recommendation

The three options address aspects of the problem that are related but not the same. The first option tells you when replenishment is needed and alerts the staff. Option 2 offers a simple and inexpensive method of keeping the displays stocked. Option 3 shows stock quantities in one place.

If the textile store already has an inventory management system, then Option 1 should be the preferred long-term solution provided that the existing system is capable of reliable integration; it specifically deals with the gap between a clothing size becoming unavailable on display and an employee realizing the problem.

Option 2 can be introduced right away as a temporary improvement, and Option 3 can be looked at as an additional capability or as a step taken in phases, especially since employees also have difficulty finding the stockroom quantities.

When making the final investment decision, the cost of each option should be compared with the expected benefits, such as reduced lost sales, employee time savings, better stock utilization, and higher customer satisfaction. The business must carry out a feasibility study and obtain quotations from suppliers before it approves the investment.

03 Cost-Benefit Analysis

Introduction

The purpose of this Cost-Benefit Analysis is to look at the costs and the benefits that come with three solutions to the problem of missing clothing sizes on the shop-floor display even though those sizes are in the stockroom.

The three options that are being looked at are:

Option 1 – Automated Display Replenishment Notification System: This system sends a message to supervisor when clothing sizes need to be filled up

Option 2 – Manual Display Checking : This method puts an employee in charge of checking the shop-floor display two times each day and restocking any sizes that are missing.

Option 3 – Centralized Stock Visibility Dashboard: This dashboard shows the amounts of every product and size in both the stockroom and the shop floor on a shared screen.

The analysis looks at factors, operational factors and non-financial factors to find the best solution, for the cool planet store.

Cost Analysis

Initial implementation costs

Cost category	Option 1: Automated notifications	Option 2: Manual checking	Option 3: Stock dashboard
Software development or setup	Required	Minimal or not required	Required
System integration	Required	Not required	Required
Employee training	Required	Required	Required
Testing and implementation	Required	Minimal	Required
Additional equipment	May be required	Usually not required	May be required

Explanation:

- Option 1: Requires the development or purchase of a notification system and integration with the existing inventory management system.

- Option 2: Requires a checking procedure, employee allocation and a checklist to record missing sizes and replenishment activities.

- Option 3: Requires a dashboard that connects to the existing inventory system and displays stock quantities accurately.

Ongoing operational costs

Cost category	Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
Software maintenance	Required	Not normally required	Required
Employee time	Monitoring alerts and replenishing stock	Checking displays twice daily	Reviewing dashboard information and replenishing stock
System support	May be required	Minimal	May be required
Staff training	Occasional updates	Refresher training when needed	Occasional updates
Data accuracy checks	Required	Required	Required

Option 2 has fewer technical requirements but requires employees to spend time checking displays regularly. Options 1 and 3 require more technical support but may reduce manual work and improve stock visibility.

Benefit Analysis

Expected benefit	Option 1: Automated notifications	Option 2: Manual checking	Option 3: Stock dashboard
Improved clothing size availability	High	Medium	Medium to High
Reduced employee monitoring time	High	Low	Medium
Faster replenishment	High	Medium	Medium
Improved stock visibility	Medium	Low	High
Reduced missed sales opportunities	High	Medium	Medium to High
Improved customer satisfaction	High	Medium	High
Better stock utilization	High	Medium	High
Improved management decisions	Medium	Low	High

Expected benefits include recovered sales opportunities because customers are more likely to buy when the sizes, they want are actually available in the store.

Employees can work efficiently since they spend less time looking for missing sizes and more time helping customers. This improves employee productivity.

There is use of existing inventory. Stockroom items can be moved to the shop floor quickly when needed, reducing waste and improving availability.

Customers are happier because they find the products and sizes, they need without hassle. This leads to customer satisfaction.

Management gains insights into stock issues. With real-time visibility and records on replenishment it's easier to spot patterns and fix recurring problems, with stock availability. These outcomes are expected after the changes are made. They need to be checked and confirmed once everything is up and running.

04. Risk Register

Introduction

The Risk Register is meant to spot, examine and control risks that come from putting the proposed solutions into practice for the clothing display replenishment problem, in the cool planet store.

Our current inventory management system keeps track of stock amounts. Customers might not see the clothing sizes they need on the shop-floor display if replenishment takes too long. This can cause customer dissatisfaction lost sales chances and waste of employee time.

The Risk Register looks at risks linked to the three options: Option 1: Automated Display Replenishment Notification System. Option 2: Manual Display Checking. Option 3: Centralized Stock Visibility Dashboard. The Risk Register lists each risk how likely it is, how big the impact is, how important it is, who is responsible and what actions must be taken to lower or control it.

Risk Register Table

Risk ID	Identified risk	Likelihood	Impact	Risk level	Mitigation strategy
02	Inventory records may be inaccurate, resulting in incorrect replenishment notifications or dashboard information	High	High	High	Conduct regular stock reconciliations and update inventory records promptly
05	The automated notification system may experience technical failures or downtime.	Medium	High	High	Conduct regular testing and maintenance and establish a manual backup procedure.

07	The project may exceed the planned budget or implementation schedule.	Medium	High	High	Prepare a realistic project plan, monitor progress and control changes to requirements.
08	The centralized dashboard may display outdated stock quantities if data is not updated in real time or at suitable intervals.	Medium	High	High	Define data refresh requirements and verify the accuracy of stock updates
10	Employees may have difficulty identifying the correct product or size during replenishment.	Medium	Medium	Medium	Use clear product codes, size labels and standardized stock location information.
12	Employees may continue using informal manual procedures instead of the new system, reducing its effectiveness	Medium	Medium	Medium	stablish standard operating procedures and monitor compliance.

Key Risks Requiring Immediate Attention

The following risks should receive attention during planning and implementation.

– Inaccurate inventory records (High priority)

Inaccurate inventory records cause employees to receive alerts or to make wrong restock decisions. Inaccurate inventory records should be checked before the solution is implemented.

– System integration difficulties (High priority)

System integration difficulties may cause the notification system or dashboard to fail with the existing inventory system. System integration difficulties must be confirmed for feasibility before the development is approved.

– Delayed response to notifications (priority)

Delayed response to notifications may still cause customers to face problems even if the system spots missing sizes. Delayed response, to notifications requires responsibilities and response procedures.

Risk Monitoring and Review

Risk monitoring and review is important. It should not stop after the planning part of the project is done. It needs to keep happening through the project.

The Project Manager has to look at the risks connected to the project. They need to keep the Risk Register up to date.

The IT Manager has to watch system integration. They also need to check data accuracy. They should make sure access control is working. They have to watch for failures.

The Store Manager must check if employees are following the rules. They need to watch for delays, in restocking. They should look at what customers saying

The Inventory Manager must check the stock records. They should look into why certain products missing in size again and again.

Any new risk or big change must be written down. It needs to be checked and given to someone to handle.

The Risk Register must be looked at during project meetings. It should also be checked during system testing. When the project starts. After everything is set up management should see if the controls are helping with display shortages. They should also check if restocking is better.

Final Recommendation

Based on the options appraisal, cost-benefit analysis and risk assessment it is recommended that the textile store implement the Automated Display Replenishment Notification System as the long-term solution to improve clothing size availability on the shop-floor display.

The existing inventory management system records stock quantities. It does not adequately address the timely replenishment of clothing sizes displayed in the store. As a result, customers may be unable to find their required sizes even when those sizes are available in the stockroom. This situation can lead to customer dissatisfaction missed sales opportunities and inefficient use of employee time.

The proposed automated notification system will connect to the existing inventory management system. Notify employees when displayed clothing sizes need replenishment. This will enable employees to identify shortages and transfer available stock from the stockroom to the shop floor. The system is expected to reduce delays improve employee productivity increase product availability and enhance the customer shopping experience.

Before implementation management should confirm the compatibility of the proposed system with the existing inventory management system assess resource requirements and establish clear responsibilities for responding to notifications. Staff training, system testing, accurate inventory records and regular performance monitoring will also be essential to implementation.

It is recommended that the business introduce the solution through a pilot implementation in one store or selected clothing section. The results should be evaluated using performance indicators such as replenishment response time, display size availability, number of missed replenishment tasks and customer feedback. Based on the results management can decide whether to extend the system to departments or branches.

In conclusion the Automated Display Replenishment Notification System offers a long-term approach to addressing the identified business problem. Its implementation, supported by risk management and continuous monitoring is expected to improve operational efficiency make better use of existing inventory reduce missed sales opportunities and support higher customer satisfaction. Final approval should be subject to confirming feasibility implementation requirements and the expected business benefits.